Chapter 1

Me and My Family



Let's Recollect

We have already learnt about many types of families and roles of different members in a family. In this chapter, you will learn about different relatives, family as a support system and the concept of similarity between relations and hereditary features.

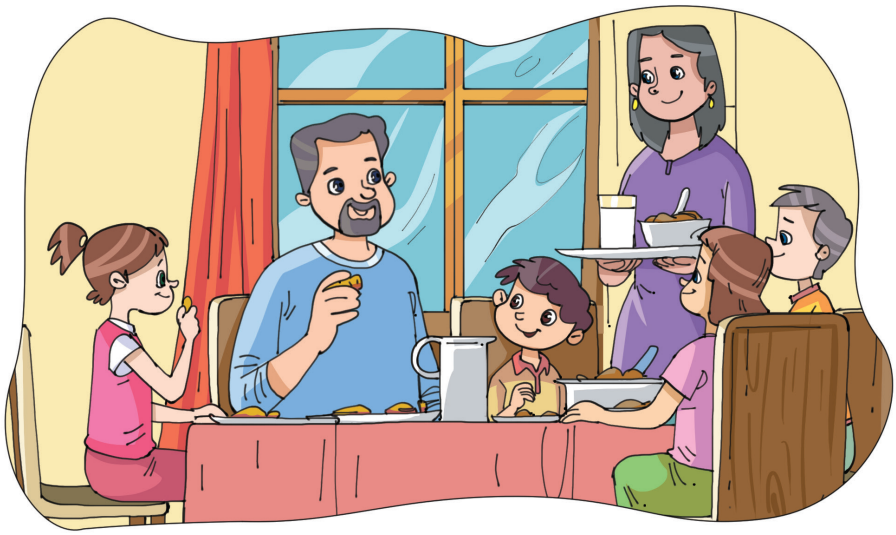
Family

A group of people consisting of parents and their children is a family. A family may be big or small.

A small family, also called a nuclear family, has one set of parents with one or two children. A big family has one set of parents with more than two children. A joint family has more than one set of parents living with their children. A family can be both big and small.



A small family



A big family



A big joint family

Need for a Family

A newborn baby needs a lot of care and protection. The family looks after a child's growth, education and other needs. Family is rightly called the first school of a child because he or she learns many things from the family before stepping out into the outside world. A child learns about the culture and values of life from the family. All elementary habits are developed in the family environment. The child learns how to speak, work and behave in different situations. Each member of the family is closely linked.

Relate

- Who lives with you at home?
- How many members are there in your family?
- What type of family do you have?

Family life is influenced by all its members. Our family supports and shares all our joys and sorrows. We must cooperate with our family members. Remember that caring and sharing are the two pillars of a happy family.

Our Family

We are related to all the members of our family.

There are many relatives who do not live with us. We usually meet them during family functions, vacations and festivals. Whenever we meet, we have a great time. We play with our cousins.

Relate

- Have you learnt anything from anybody in your family?
- Whom do you admire the most in your family?

Let us meet Ravi.





Mr Gopal Das is my father's father. He is my grandfather.

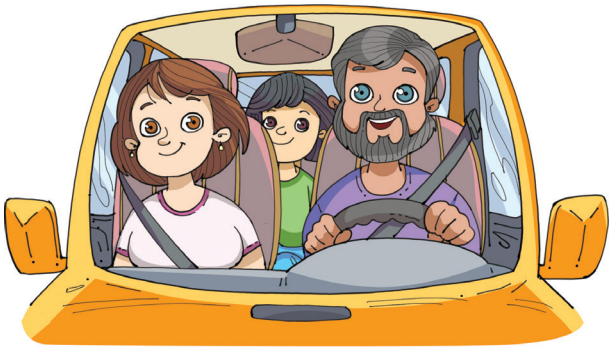
Mrs Rita Das is my father's mother. She is my grandmother.

I am their grandchild. I love my grandparents very much. They too love me very much.



Mr Rohan Das is my grandfather's son. He is my father. My father is the manager in a bank.

Mrs Monica Das is my father's wife. She is my mother. My mother runs an NGO for the welfare of women and children.



Mr Sumit Das is my father's brother.

He is my uncle. His wife is my aunt.

My uncle lives with my aunt and their daughter in another city.

Mrs Sushma Saini is my father's sister. She is my aunt. Her husband is my uncle.

My aunt stays with my uncle in another state and visit our place during festivals and holidays.





Nupur and Paras are my aunt's children. They are my cousins.

I have a great time with my cousins whenever they visit us. We love to play video games.

Relate

- **How do you address your family members? For example, father's father, father's mother, father's brother, father's sister, etc.**
- **When do you meet the members of your family who do not live with you?**
- **Do you look forward to meeting them?**

We talk to our grandparents and listen to stories from them. My mother and aunts work together in the kitchen and make special dishes for us. My uncle brings lots of gifts for all of us.

He is the most caring and patient person in our family. He spends a lot of time with all of us.

Family union is very important for children as it teaches them values and traditions of the family. Such occasions help the family to bond well with one another.



Family Tree

A family tree shows the relationship between different members of a family.

Let us now see Ravi's family tree that shows three generations. Grandparents belong to the first generation.

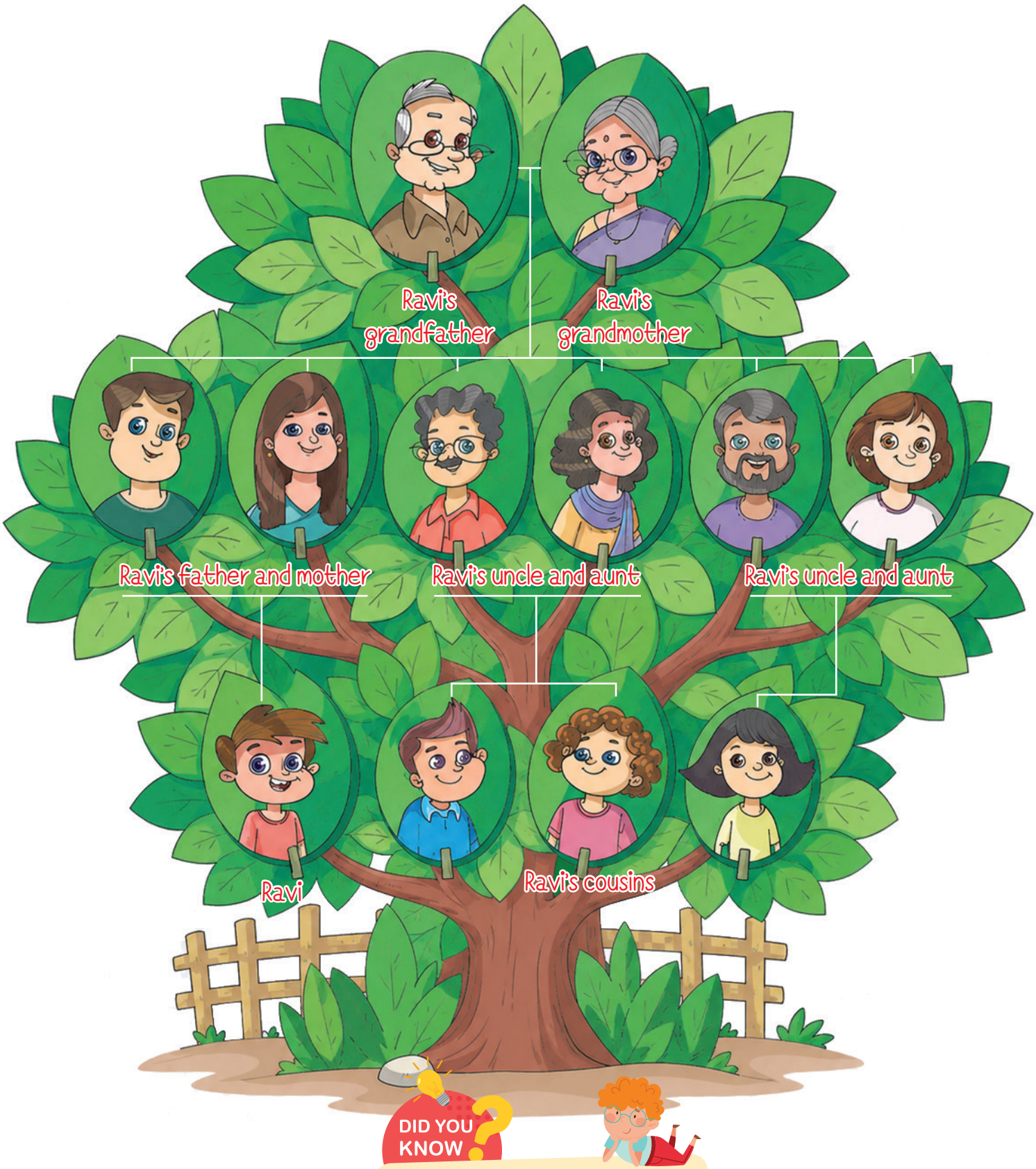
Parents, uncles and aunts belong to the second generation.

Their children belong to the third generation.

The family tree extends with the addition of a new member. When anyone in the family gets married, a new relative is added to the family. Birth of a baby also adds a new member in the family.

Relate

- **Do you have any relative who used to live with you but does not live with you now?**
- **Are you expecting a new relative in future?**



DID YOU KNOW

India's average family has 4.8 members per household.

Similarities and Differences in Family

Members of a family may resemble each other. Usually, there are similarities between the members of a family in their looks, habits, attitudes, etc. These similarities, which are passed on from one generation to another, are called hereditary features. Many brothers and sisters may have identical features but they may be entirely different in their behaviours, likes or dislikes.

Relate

- Have you ever seen twins?
- How alike did they look?



Most children resemble their parents but there are some who do not. Some children may even look like their uncle, aunt, grandparents or cousins.

Children born at the same time to a mother are called twins. Some twins look identical. Some look absolutely different from each other they are called fraternal twins. Identical twins are always two boys or two girls.

Overview of the Chapter

- Family is a group of people consisting of parents and their children.
- Families are of many types—small family, big family and joint family.
- Family is rightly called the first school of a child because he or she learns many things from the family members before stepping out into the outside world.
- You are related to all the members of your family.
- Family union is very important for children because it teaches them values and traditions of the family.
- A family tree is a tree which shows the relationship between different members of the family.
- The similarities which are passed on from one generation to another are called hereditary features.
- Twins are the children born to the same mother at the same time.



A. Answer the following questions.

1. What is a family?
2. Why do we need a family?
3. What is a family tree?
4. What are hereditary features?
5. Who are twins?
6. What features have you inherited from your family members?

B. Fill in the blanks.

1. A _____ family has one set of parents with one or two children.
2. Family is called our _____ as we learn many things from our family members before anywhere else.
3. Father's father is called _____.
4. Uncles' and aunts' children are our _____.
5. _____ are children born at the same time to a mother.
6. A child learns values from its _____.

C. Write any five things that you have learnt from your family.

_____

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